

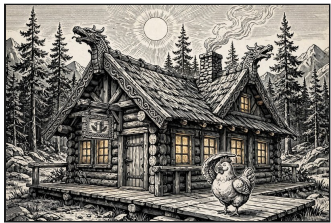
THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

PAYSON, ARIZONA · SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 · Morning Edition — Vol. 2609, No. 26 · PRICE: ONE SEPTIM



The Hearth's chicken, basking in the sunshine with a wing over its eyes.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

82° / 59°

Mostly sunny

Sunrise 6:16 AM · Sunset 6:16 PM

Tomorrow — Showers possible, 77/58

AROUND THE HOLD · THE WEEK AHEAD

Saturday Brims With Doings Across the Holds



By the Dude — Payson, Ariz.



Pipers, caber-tossers, and bull riders take the day across the Holds.

Hail and well met, wayfarers of the Rim! The sun climbs bold over the pines this fine Saturday, and the Holds are fairly bursting with doings — pipers and

caber-tossers gather at Watson Lake, bull riders take the arena in Prescott Valley tonight, and Thursday brings the granddaddy of them all: the 72nd Northern Gila County

Fair with its brand-new B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival. Fill your mug, friend — here is the week ahead.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY



Payson

— Taste at the Bridge — food and wine tasting at Tonto Natural Bridge State Park, 5 PM.



Sedona

— SoulShyne Band — live music at PJ's Pub, Village of Oak Creek, 6 PM.

— ELEVATE: September Edition — DJ night with STARLORD & Lady Merkaba at Humankind, 1730 W SR 89A, 8 PM; \$14, sober bar.



Show Low

— Pinetop-Lakeside Fall Festival Parade — annual parade, this year's theme "Stars, Stripes & the American Spirit," Saturday morning.

— 42nd Annual Run to the Pines Car Show — 575 vehicles at Pinetop Lakes Golf & Country Club, 8 AM–4 PM; free entry with a non-perishable food donation.

— White Mountain Soup Fest — taste and vote on soups at the White Mountain Community Center, Lakeside, noon–4 PM; \$10, proceeds fight hunger.



Prescott

— Prescott Highland Games & Celtic Faire — bagpipes, heavy athletics, highland dance, axe throwing, and scotch tasting at Watson Lake Park, 9 AM–5 PM; \$15.

— Prescott Cars & Coffee — monthly community car show at Pine Ridge Marketplace, 8–10 AM.

— Mile High Bull Bash — PRCA and PBR riders versus top bulls at Findlay Toyota Center, Prescott Valley; doors 6 PM, show 7:30 PM.

THE DAYS AHEAD

• Sunday, Sept. 27

— Prescott Highland Games & Celtic Faire — second and final day at Watson Lake Park, 9 AM–4 PM; \$15, under 5 free.

— Sedona Community Farmers Market — weekly market with local harvest, artisan goods, and live music; Wells Fargo lot, 2201 W SR 89A, West Sedona, 8 AM–12 PM.

• Monday, Sept. 28

— Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose — songs, poetry, and storytelling at THAT Brewery & Pub, 3270 N Hwy 87, Pine, 4 PM; tips benefit Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction.

• Tuesday, Sept. 29

— Trail Day Volunteer Build — help build trail with Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction, Hwy 87 dirt turnout, Pine, 7 AM–12 PM; tools provided, no experience needed.

• Thursday, Oct. 1

— Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival — the 72nd annual fair opens at the Payson Event Center, 1400 S Beeline Hwy, gates 9 AM, through Saturday; bull riding, ranch rodeo, livestock shows, fiddle festival, carnival rides, and an opening ceremony honoring local heroes.

— Sedona Yoga Festival — four-day conference at Outbound Sedona, 1752 AZ-179, 8 AM–5 PM daily; 150+ sessions of yoga, sound healing, and keynotes.

• Friday, Oct. 2

— Northern Gila County Fair, Day Two — professional bull riding takes the arena at 6 PM; the fair runs through Saturday at the Payson Event Center.

— Prescott Area Artist Studio Tour — 52 studios and 74 artists open their doors across the Prescott area, 10 AM–4 PM daily through Sunday; free and self-guided.

— North Inch Renaissance Faire — a brand-new faire of pyrates and faeries at 1504 W Country Club Dr, Payson, from 9 AM.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Due today — measure the flame bulb and socket, then find or design a wall-torch sconce model.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Oct. 3 — two torches plus the socket test piece; test-fit the bulb before the full print.

The torch sconce designs must leave the drafting table — the Hearth's walls await their light!



The torch sconces take shape on the workbench — measure twice, print once.

WORD FROM THE PAYSON HOLD



The Payson Town Council holds no meeting in the coming week — its last regular meeting was Wednesday, September 23. The next regular meeting is Wednesday, October 14, at 4 PM in the Town Council Chambers at Town Hall, 303 N Beeline Highway.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Common Grounds Coffee House · Payson



The coffee house as our engraver imagines it — pastries, pines, and plenty of mugs.

A cozy neighborhood coffee house on Colcord Road, tucked under the pines. The signature Lavender Bee Latte — made with lavender sugar from a Pine farm and local Boyd's honey — shares the menu with homemade cranberry bread, chocolate chip muffins, and fresh-baked treats. Indoor and patio seating, takeout, and prices that keep it an everyday stop.

“Regulars on Google call it their favorite coffee shop in Payson — cozy inside, a patio right under the pines, and shelves of local products from neighboring makers.” — a Google review

219 S Colcord Rd, Payson — (928) 970-2540. Open daily 6:30 AM–4 PM. Inexpensive. Good to know: the back patio sits right under the pines — the finest seat in the house on a sunny morning. · [their website](#)

Why the Hearth sends you:

The Hearth sends its guests here for the coziest cup in the Hold — honest baking, a pine-shaded patio, and honey from just down the road.

THE PIES THAT WOULDN'T BUDGE



Jethro parades the windowsill — pies and all — while Gus gives chase.

Gus sets his berry pies on the tavern windowsill every Saturday to cool, and every Saturday the whole forest knows better than to touch them. Every Saturday except this one.

Flurry was only trying to help. “Just a breath,” he said, all big-eyed and earnest, and gave those pies the tiniest puff of his ice-breath. The pies froze to the sill. Not frosted — welded. Gus tapped one with a knuckle and it rang like a dinner bell.

“Oh no,” Gus whispered, which for Gus is practically shouting.

Now, Jethro does not always think things through, but Jethro has shoulders like oak beams and a heart to match. “Stand back,” he said, wrapped those enormous arms around the windowsill, and pulled.

The sill came with him. So did the pies. So did a fair piece of the tavern wall’s dignity. He paraded through the clearing holding the whole windowsill over his head like a trophy, pies and all, grinning that big Mogollon grin, while Gus chased after him wailing, “My sill! My pies! My Saturday!” Earl watched from the woodpile with enormous dignity and said nothing, which said everything.

Mabel thawed the pies with warm towels and declared them, quote, “structurally improved.”